



A complete, curriculum-aligned daily te reo Māori programme for NZ Years 5–6

Designed for English-medium primary schools · Aligned to **Te Aho Arataki Marau mā te Ako i Te Reo Māori — Kura Auraki** · Curriculum Levels 1–2

40

Weeks

200

Lessons

4

Terms

12

Achievement Objectives

24

Grammar Structures

Programme overview

Te Reo Māori Warm-Up is a structured, daily 20-minute programme designed to give Years 5–6 students a genuine, cumulative foundation in te reo Māori across the full school year. It uses the proven Michel Thomas discovery method — students build sentences themselves through guided questions rather than memorising rules — within a predictable daily structure that teachers can deliver confidently regardless of their own te reo proficiency.

Every lesson, every week, and every term is directly mapped to the achievement objectives and grammar levels of **Te Aho Arataki Marau mā te Ako i Te Reo Māori — Kura Auraki** (Curriculum Guidelines for Teaching and Learning Te Reo Māori in English-medium Schools, Years 1–13). By the end of the year, students can hold a simple spontaneous conversation entirely in te reo Māori.

Discovery-based learning	Michel Thomas method: students discover rules through building, not memorising. No rote learning.
Spiral curriculum	Every skill is revisited once per term in a new, more complex context — deepening rather than repeating.
Predictable daily structure	Three stages every lesson: Tāua Kōrero (I Do), Kia Tāhono (We Do), Māu Anā (You Do). Students know what to expect.
Full curriculum coverage	All 12 Achievement Objectives and all 24 grammar structures from Levels 1–2 are addressed across the year.
Six language modes	Listening, speaking, reading, writing, viewing, and presenting are all built into the weekly programme.

NZ cultural context

All examples, scenarios, and vocabulary use NZ settings, tikanga, and te ao Māori — no adaptation required.

THE DAILY STRUCTURE

Every lesson: 20 minutes, three stages

The programme follows the internationally proven **gradual release of responsibility** model — known in te reo Māori as the three whāinga (purposes) of each session. The structure is identical every day so that both teachers and students can move through it efficiently, spending time on language rather than logistics.

■ Tūua Kōrero (I Do)

~6 min

Teacher-led discovery

The teacher presents the new structure, vocabulary, or pattern. Students watch, listen, and discover. No notes — the focus is on hearing and absorbing. Key examples are shown large on screen for whole-class viewing. Every example can be expanded to full-screen for whiteboard display.

■ Kia Tūhono (We Do)

~8 min

Guided class construction

The teacher prompts, the class constructs sentences together. Students contribute answers, discuss choices, and build on each other's responses. The teacher uses questioning rather than telling — "What would come next?" "How would we change this for 'she'?" Sentences can be clicked to display full-screen.

⇒ Mōu Anō (You Do)

~6 min

Independent application

3–4 independent challenges. Students build sentences from prompts using everything they have learned. Tasks are spoken, written, or both. A bonus extension challenge is included every day for students who are ready to go further. A countdown timer is built into every stage.

The five-day week

MONDAY

~20 min

Kupu hou

New vocabulary + pronunciation.

TUESDAY

~20 min

Hanganga

Grammar structure. The new pattern,

WEDNESDAY

~20 min

Hanga rerenga

Sentence building. Combine this week's

THURSDAY

~20 min

Kōrero

Conversation in context. Roleplay,

FRIDAY

~30 min

Aromatawai

Team quiz game show (8 Qs) +

Friday assessment

Every Friday the lesson is replaced by two components: a **team quiz game show** (8 questions, 2 from each day's lesson, with 4 plausible answer options that shuffle each game to prevent memorisation) and a **spoken assessment task** where students hold a short conversation or perform a language challenge using the week's structures. The quiz is team-based with a live scoreboard displayed on the classroom screen. The spoken task includes a student self-assessment checklist aligned to the week's specific skills.

Achievement objectives coverage — Levels 1 and 2

The programme is mapped directly to **Te Aho Arataki Marau mō te Ako i Te Reo Māori — Kura Auraki**, the Ministry of Education curriculum guidelines for teaching te reo Māori in English-medium schools. Years 5–6 students working at NZ Curriculum Levels 2–3 are addressed by **Curriculum Levels 1 and 2** of the language progression. All twelve achievement objectives across both levels are explicitly addressed within this programme.

Code	Achievement objective	Term 1	Term 2	Term 3	Term 4
AO 1.1	Greet, farewell, and acknowledge people; respond to greetings	●	●	●	●
AO 1.2	Introduce self and others; respond to introductions	●	●		●
AO 1.3	Communicate about number, days of the week, months, dates	●	●	●	●
AO 1.4	Communicate personal information (name, iwi, hapū, maunga, awa, home)	●		●	●
AO 1.5	Communicate about location	●	●	●	●
AO 1.6	Understand and use simple politeness conventions	●	●	●	●
AO 1.7	Use and respond to simple classroom language	■		●	●
AO 2.1	Communicate about relationships between people		●	●	●
AO 2.2	Communicate about possessions (■/■ categories)			●	●
AO 2.3	Communicate about likes, dislikes, and reasons	●	●	●	●
AO 2.4	Communicate about time, weather, and seasons		●	●	●
AO 2.5	Communicate about physical characteristics, personality, and feelings	●	●	●	●

● Addressed this term ■ Introduced/embedded from Term 1 as daily classroom language

The six language modes — Ara Reo

Te Aho Arataki Marau specifies six modes of language learning: Whakarongo (listening), Kōrero (speaking), Pānui (reading), Tuhituhi (writing), Mātakitaki (viewing), and Whakaatu (presenting). All six are addressed within the daily programme structure.

Whakarongo — Listening	Kōrero — Speaking	Pānui — Reading
Every Tūua Kōrero (I Do) stage daily. Thursday conversation roleplay. Friday quiz (questions read aloud).	Kia Tūhono (We Do) responses daily. Thursday full conversation. Friday spoken challenge every week.	Māu Anā written tasks from Term 1 Wk 3. Reading kupu on screen/board daily. Friday written option.
Tuhituhi — Writing	Mātakitaki — Viewing	Whakaatu — Presenting
You Do written tasks weekly. Friday written alternative. Portfolio evidence from Term 3 onwards.	Full-screen lesson displays. Visual vocabulary cards daily. Whiteboard I Do stage. Kupu colour-coded on screen.	Term 3 Wk 5 classroom commands. Term 4 Wk 9 students present to class. Term 4 Wk 10 one-minute kōrero.

THE SPIRAL CURRICULUM — 40 WEEKS IN DETAIL

How the spiral works

Every skill domain in the programme is revisited once per term — four times across the year — in a new context and at increasing depth. This means students never simply "move on" from a structure; they return to it with a more sophisticated vocabulary and greater independence. A student who learned *Kei te haere au* (I am going) in Term 1 Week 3 will use that same structure in Term 2 to describe past events, in Term 3 to discuss future plans, and in Term 4 in a full spontaneous conversation.

Skill domain	Term 1	Term 2	Term 3	Term 4
Vocabulary	People, actions, food, places	Feelings, time, nature, colours	School, community, body, weather	Opinion, quantity, formal review
Grammar	Kei te (present), Ko, He	I (past), Ka (story), Kōre (negation)	E...ana, future, possession ■/■	All tenses, complex sentences
Pronouns & numbers	au, koe, ia + 1–10	Plural pronouns + 11–100	Possessives tēku/tēku + ordinals	All pronouns fluently, time/date
Conversation	Greetings, introductions, yes/no	Questions: ki hea, i te aha, pēhea	Requests, commands, because/so	Multi-turn dialogue, storytelling

Term 1 — Tūhūatanga (Foundations)

Wk	Focus	AOs
1	Greetings, vowels, Kia ora	1.1 1.6
2	Ko wai? Names and Ko structure	1.2 1.4
3	Food vocab + Kei te (present tense)	1.5 2.5
4	Places + ki (direction)	1.5 1.6
5	Verbs + hiahia ki te (want to)	2.3 1.6
6	Numbers 1–10 + E hia?	1.3 1.5
7	Feelings + Kei te [feeling] au	2.5 1.6
8	nā te mea (because) + sentence linking	2.3 1.6
9	Review + mini-dialogue	1.1 1.2 2.5
10	Spiral review + spoken assessment	1.1 1.2 1.3 1.5 2.3 2.5

Term 2 — Kia Tipu (Growing)

Wk	Focus	AOs
1	Past tense: I haere au	1.5 2.3
2	Ka (narrative/future)	2.3 1.5
3	Negation: Kōre e...ana / i	2.3 1.6
4	māua/tāua — we two (plural pronouns)	2.1 1.6

5	kōrua, rōua, mōtou, rōtou	2.1 2.5
6	Numbers 11–20, tekau mā...	1.3 1.5
7	Numbers to 100	1.3 1.5
8	Colours: whero, kōkōriki...	2.5 1.6
9	Comparatives: He...ake	2.5 2.3
10	Spiral review T1+T2 + describe a day	1.1 1.3 2.1 2.3 2.5

Term 3 — Kia Rea (Deepening)

Wk	Focus	AOs
1	Body parts + E...ana (progressive)	2.5 1.5
2	Weather + Ka...te rangi	2.4 1.5
3	Possession ■-category (tōku/tōu)	2.2 1.4
4	Possession ■-category (tōku/tōu)	2.2 2.3
5	Classroom commands: Tōhia! Pōnuihia!	1.7 1.6
6	Community: marae, hapū, iwi, Nō hea?	1.4 2.1
7	Future tense: Ka...pōpō / Mōku e...	2.4 2.3
8	Time words: pōpō, inanahi, ināianei	2.4 1.3
9	Conjunctions: engari, nō reira	2.3 2.5
10	Spiral review all terms + weekly story	1.1 1.4 2.1 2.2 2.4 2.5

Term 4 — Kia Mārama (Fluency)

Wk	Focus	AOs
1	Emotions + waiata vocab + tense review	2.5 2.3
2	Formal greetings: Tōnō koe/kōrua/koutou	1.1 1.2 1.4 1.6
3	Adverbs: tino, hua, kōtahi	2.5 2.3
4	Quantity: tini, maha, ruarua	1.3 2.2
5	All question types rapid review	1.3 1.4 1.5 2.4
6	Storytelling + Ka/I/Ka chains	2.3 2.5
7	Opinion: pai ake, kino ake	2.3 2.5
8	Full year vocabulary review	1.1 1.2 1.3 1.4 1.5 2.1
9	Celebration + waiata + class presentation	1.1 1.6 2.5
10	Year review + 1-min spontaneous kōrero	1.1 1.2 1.3 1.4 1.5 1.6 1.7 2.1 2.2 2.3 2.4 2.5

END-OF-YEAR MILESTONES AND EXPECTED OUTCOMES

What students can do — term by term

The programme has clear, measurable milestones at the end of each term. These are observable through the weekly Friday spoken challenge and the end-of-term assessment conversation, and can be used as evidence of progress against Te Aho Arataki Marau achievement objectives.

End of Term 1	- Greet and farewell someone using Kia ora or Tēnā koe - Introduce themselves: Ko [name] tēku ingoa - Ask and answer: Kei te pēhea koe? / Kei te pai au - Say what they are doing now: Kei te [verb] au - Describe something: He [noun] [adjective] - Count and ask prices: E hia? / E [number] tāra - Use simple politeness: E, Kō, Kia ora
End of Term 2	- Retell a past event: I haere au ki te kura - Tell a story in sequence using Ka - Use negation: Kōre au e kai ana / Kōre au i haere - Use all plural pronouns correctly (māua, tāua, mātou, tātou...) - Count to 100 and use numbers in real contexts - Describe objects using colours and comparatives - Ask and answer who/what/where/how questions
End of Term 3	- Describe ongoing actions: E haere ana ia - Talk about the weather and seasons - Use - and -category possessives correctly (tēku, tēku) - Give and follow classroom instructions in te reo - State where they are from and discuss hapū/iwi - Talk about future plans: Ka haere au pēpē - Use time words: pēpē, inanahi, ināianei - Sustain a short scripted conversation on a familiar topic
End of Term 4	- Hold a 1-minute spontaneous conversation entirely in te reo Māori - Use formal greetings in appropriate contexts (Tēnā koutou) - Express opinions and preferences: He pai ake tēnei - Tell a story across multiple tenses (I..., Ka..., Ka...) - Ask and answer all question types fluently - Use adverbs of degree: tino pai, hua nui - Self-correct when they make an error

Technology and delivery

Delivery format	Browser-based HTML application. Runs on any device with a modern browser — interactive whiteboard, teacher laptop, or classroom display. No installation required.
Teacher preparation	Zero. Every lesson is fully scripted with vocabulary, examples, guided sentences, and tasks. The app displays everything on-screen. Teachers do not need to be fluent in te reo Māori.
Friday quiz	Auto-generated for each week. 8 questions, 4 plausible options each, options shuffle every game to prevent memorisation. Team scoreboard displayed on screen. No teacher setup.
Full-screen mode	Any example sentence or demonstration can be expanded to full-screen for whiteboard display. Built-in countdown timer for each stage.
Curriculum tags	Every lesson displays its Te Aho Arataki Marau achievement objective codes on screen, clickable for teachers to see the full curriculum link during delivery.
Assessment evidence	Friday spoken tasks include student self-assessment checklists aligned to the week's specific skills. Can be collected as portfolio evidence.

"Ko te reo te manawa pou o te Māori." Te reo Māori Warm-Up gives every student in this school a structured, joyful, and curriculum-aligned pathway into te reo Māori — twenty minutes a day, building something real.